

ADDISON DISEASE

(OR CHRONIC ADRENAL INSUFFICIENCY)

- Failure of adrenal cortex to secrete corticosteroids.

TYPES OF ADDISON DISEASE

- a. **Primary Addison Disease:** Due to adrenal cause.
- b. **Secondary Addison Disease:** Due to failure of anterior pituitary to secrete ACTH.
- c. **Tertiary Addison Disease:** Due to failure of hypothalamus to secrete Corticotropin-Releasing Factor (CRF).

CAUSES FOR PRIMARY ADDISON DISEASE

- a. **Atrophy of adrenal cortex** due to autoimmune disease.
- b. **Destruction of gland** becoz of tuberculosis.
- c. **Destruction of hormone-secreting cells** in adrenal cortex by malignant tissues.
- d. **Congenital failure** to secrete cortisol.
- e. **Adrenalectomy** and failure to take hormone therapy.

SIGNS AND SYMPTOMS

- Symptoms becoz of deficiency of both cortisol + aldosterone.
- Common signs & symptoms :—
 - a. **Pigmentation of skin and mucous membrane:**
 - ↓ *Due to excess ACTH secretion*
 - ⇔ Cause pigmentation by **melanocyte-stimulation action**.
 - b. **Muscular weakness**
 - c. **Dehydration** with loss of sodium.
 - d. **Hypotension**

- e. ↓sed cardiac output and ↓sed workload of heart, **leading to ↓se in size of heart.**
- f. **Hypoglycemia**
- g. **Nausea, vomiting, diarrhea:**
 - ⇔ Cause **dehydration & loss of body weight.**
- h. **Susceptibility to any type of infection.**
- i. **Inability to withstand any stress**, results in **Addisonian crisis.**

TEST FOR ADDISON DISEASE

- a. **Measurement of blood level** of cortisol & aldosterone.
- b. **Measurement of amount of steroids** excreted in urine.

ADDISONIAN CRISIS (ADRENAL CRISIS)

(OR ACUTE ADRENAL INSUFFICIENCY)

Common symptoms of Addison disease



Characterised by sudden collapse associated with



↑ se in need for large quantities of glucocorticoids

- **Cause :—**
 - a. Exposure to even mild stress
 - b. Hypoglycemia due to fasting
 - c. Trauma
 - d. Surgical operation
 - e. Sudden withdrawal of glucocorticoid treatment